



ALUMNI ASSOCIATION

NEWSLETTER

Newsletter #1 - Welcome, batch of 2019!

This is a special edition (and the first!) of our new Alumni newsletter. It's a welcome letter to our newest alums, the batch of 2019!

Dear Alum,

Congratulations on your graduation! IIIT-D is an institution that expects a lot out of its students, and if your tenure was anything like mine, it was probably a challenge. Sleepless nights spent on research projects, seemingly endless assignments, frantic preparation for midsems and endsems, and then scrambling for jobs and internships. I do hope that you were still able to find time to drink chai, eat Maggi and chill at Serco with friends.

The good news is that all that hard work pays off. Not only does the IIIT-D education prepare you well for industry and higher education, but it also equips you with an alumni network to support you in both your personal and professional life. On behalf of the first-ever alumni association, it's my pleasure to welcome you to the second phase of your IIIT-Delhi journey! We're excited to have you to be a part of this community.

When I graduated, the idea of an alumni association and what role I could play in it was abstract. I'd gotten a great education, made lifelong friends, and was set up for the next phase of my life. Remaining engaged with the broader IIIT-D community seemed to be a vague and optimistic aspiration.

Six years later, things feel very different. I've seen first-hand how the community in Silicon Valley has grown and flourished. I've seen community members help each other find internships & jobs, crash on couches, mentor junior folks, collaborate on projects, date and even marry! And so many have already given back in multiple ways: funding conference travel, donating, helping shape course curriculums, giving guest lectures, guiding higher-education applicants, etc.

Contributing to this community helps every student currently at IIIT, your fellow alums, and all our future alums. However, if you believe (as I do) that our culture, our education, and our practices are worth propagating, helping our alma mater succeed and become a model for others is a contribution to our broader society as well. In addition, we should also work directly to give more of the brightest school students access to our education and help them succeed without regard for their socioeconomic status. Improving education in India is in of itself something we should all be contributing towards.

What unites us is not only the name on our degrees, it's being invested in IIIT-Delhi's continued success together.

We're in many ways still a new institution, and an even newer alumni body. The alumni association is working on several exciting new initiatives, and you should expect to hear about them shortly.

I look forward to your ideas, feedback, and engagement (email me!)

Best,

Raghav Sethi '13

President, IIIT-D Alumni Association